

Travel Indent Approval Workflow

How a Principal Investigator's request to travel on project business is approved, and — separately, after the trip — how the travel bill is reimbursed. Travel is the only one of the six standard request types that runs through the office-escalation route **twice**: once to approve the trip, and again to approve the reimbursement bill.

Raised by Principal Investigator (Faculty), against a project budget head **Stages** 7 per phase, two phases

Terminal outcomes Approved (at Director) · Rejected — separately for each phase

The requested travel cost is checked against the project budget head's uncommitted balance at the time the travel request is raised, alongside any other active indents and travel claims already drawing on that same head.

PHASE 1 — TRAVEL REQUEST (INDENT)

1

Raised

Forward

The PI raises the travel request with destination, purpose, dates, and expected cost. The raiser's own stage.

2

Signed Copy Uploaded

Forward only

The signed printed travel request form is uploaded.

3

Assigned

Forward only

The office assigns the file for processing.

4

Forwarded

Forward only

General office escalation continues.

5

Forwarded to OSRC

Forward only

The file reaches the OSRC office queue. As with every request type on this route, stages 2–5 are forwarding-only for Regular Staff through Dean.

6

Forwarded to DR

Approve

Reject

Dean or Director may approve or reject the travel request.

7

Director

Approve

Reject

Final decision on whether the travel itself is approved. Approval clears the PI to travel; the trip's cost remains committed against the budget head.

WHY Travel is the only request type with a second phase because its cost isn't fully known until after the trip — actual fares, hotel bills, and per-diem receipts only exist once travel is complete. Approving the trip and approving what it actually cost are genuinely two different decisions, so the portal raises a fresh instance of the same seven-stage route for the bill.

PHASE 2 — REIMBURSEMENT BILL

Once the trip is complete, the PI submits the bill — this raises a second, independent instance of the same seven-stage route (Raised → Signed Copy Uploaded → Assigned → Forwarded → Forwarded to OSRC → Forwarded to DR → Director), carrying the TA/DA claim form and receipts instead of the travel request form. It is approved or rejected exactly the same way, with the Dean/Director and Director again the only stages that can decide.

DOCUMENTS REQUIRED

DOCUMENT	STATUS	PHASE
Generated Travel Request Form	Mandatory	Travel request
Signed Travel Request	Mandatory	Travel request
Travel Cover Letter	Mandatory	Bill
TA/DA Form with Bills and Receipts	Mandatory	Bill